

Jobs To Be Done

HOW TO UNDERSTAND WHAT YOUR
CUSTOMERS ACTUALLY WANT

with Sher Gafar

My story

**Born and raised
in Tajikistan**

In 2011 started
working on my **first
online businesses**

Moved to Germany
to **do my MBA**

**CEO and co-
founder of
Heylama** AI since
2022

**Started building
businesses at the age
of 20** - elite gym,
travel agency,
educational consulting

First exit in 2013.
menu.tj gets
acquired.

also exited from a
classified business

5 years in **digital
product
management**

Mentoring startups
since 2018.

**100+ founding
teams mentored.**

How I discovered the JTBD framework



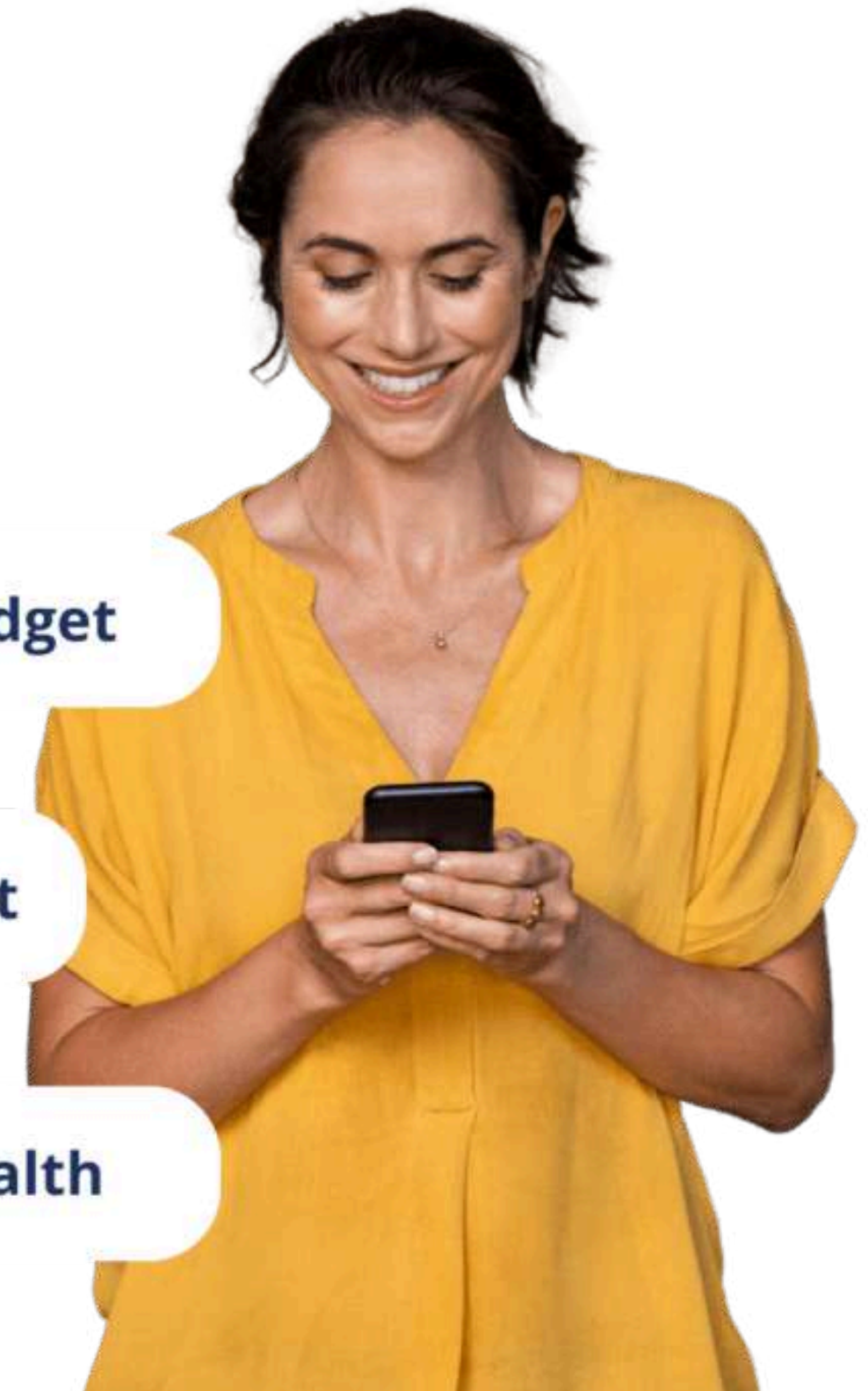
Health Budget



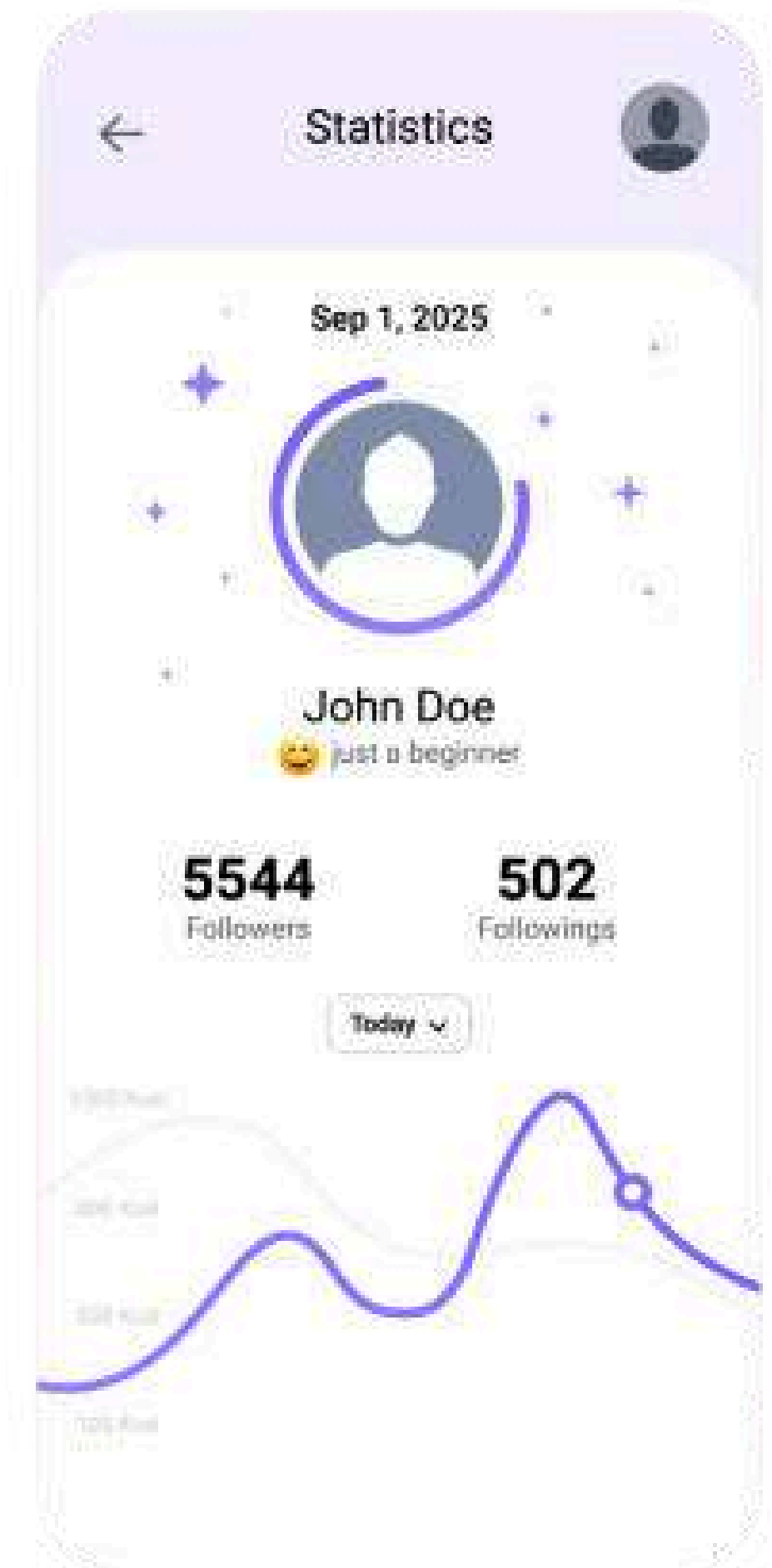
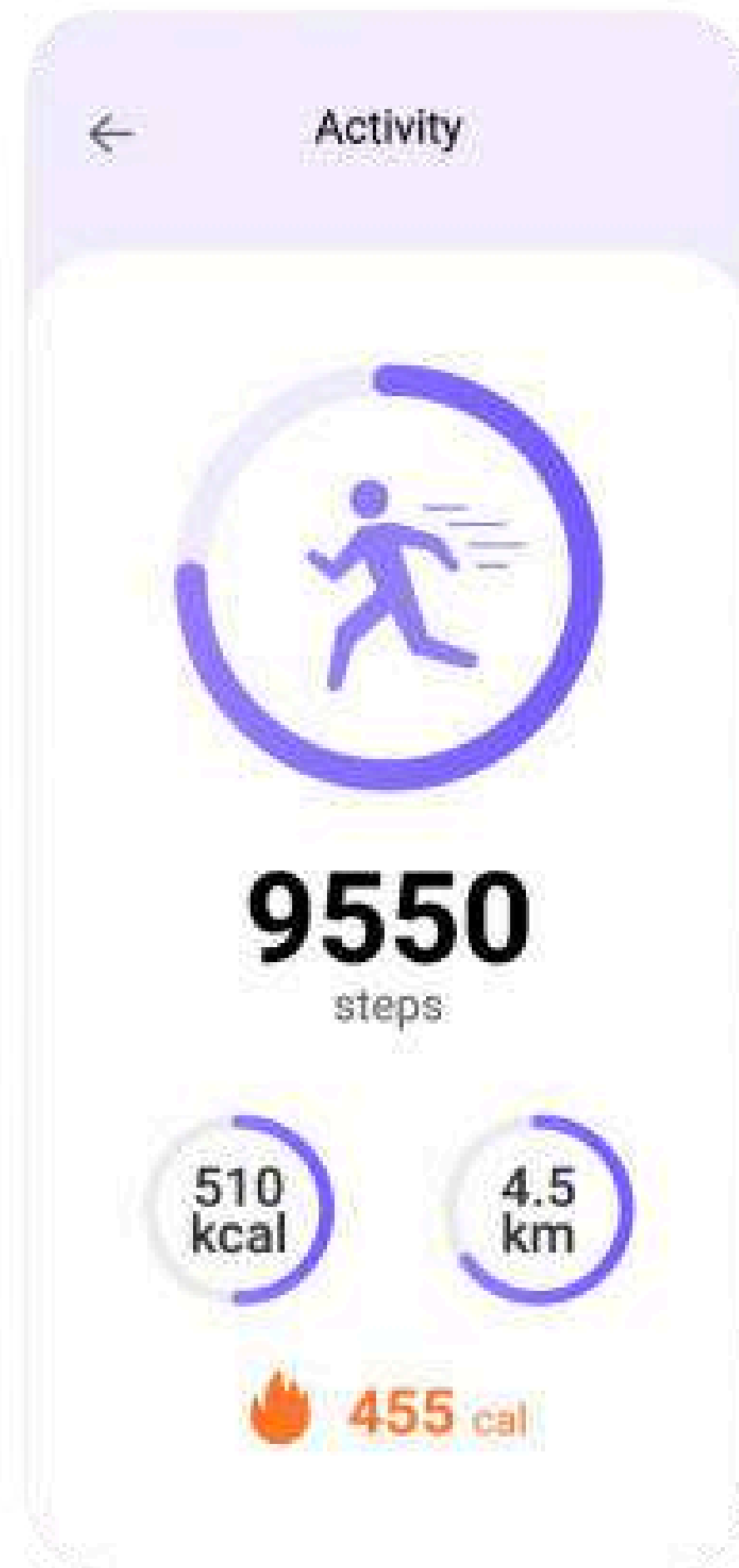
Lifestyle Budget



Mental Health



Personas and demographics didn't show the full picture..



**Our user segments
were better grouped by
expected outcomes...**



The background of the slide is a photograph of a beach scene. In the foreground, a man and a woman are jogging along the shoreline. The man is wearing a white t-shirt and dark shorts, and the woman is wearing a white t-shirt and dark leggings. They are both looking towards the right. In the background, there is a sandy beach, the ocean with gentle waves, and a coastal town with colorful houses built on a hillside. The sky is clear and blue. The overall tone of the image is bright and positive.

Our user segments
were better grouped by
expected outcomes...

***... so I needed a better way of
thinking about our users and
their needs***



Background

JTBD framework was developed in early 2000s
by Clayton Christensen from Harvard.

Three milkshakes are displayed in tall, clear glasses against a rustic wooden background. The leftmost milkshake is chocolate, topped with white cream, chocolate shavings, and fresh mint leaves. The middle milkshake is pink, topped with white cream, fresh raspberries, blueberries, and a sprig of mint. The rightmost milkshake is vanilla, topped with white cream, chocolate syrup, and several wafers. Each milkshake has a blue and white striped straw. A white text box with a black border and a hand-drawn orange line around it is superimposed over the middle of the image.

How to sell more milkshakes?

Dr. Cristensen observed 2 distinct phenomena



***I don't want a better milkshake.
I want a better commute.***



*I don't want a better milkshake.
I want a better commute.*



***Let me be a good parent by treating
my child – without feeling guilty.***



Core Premise

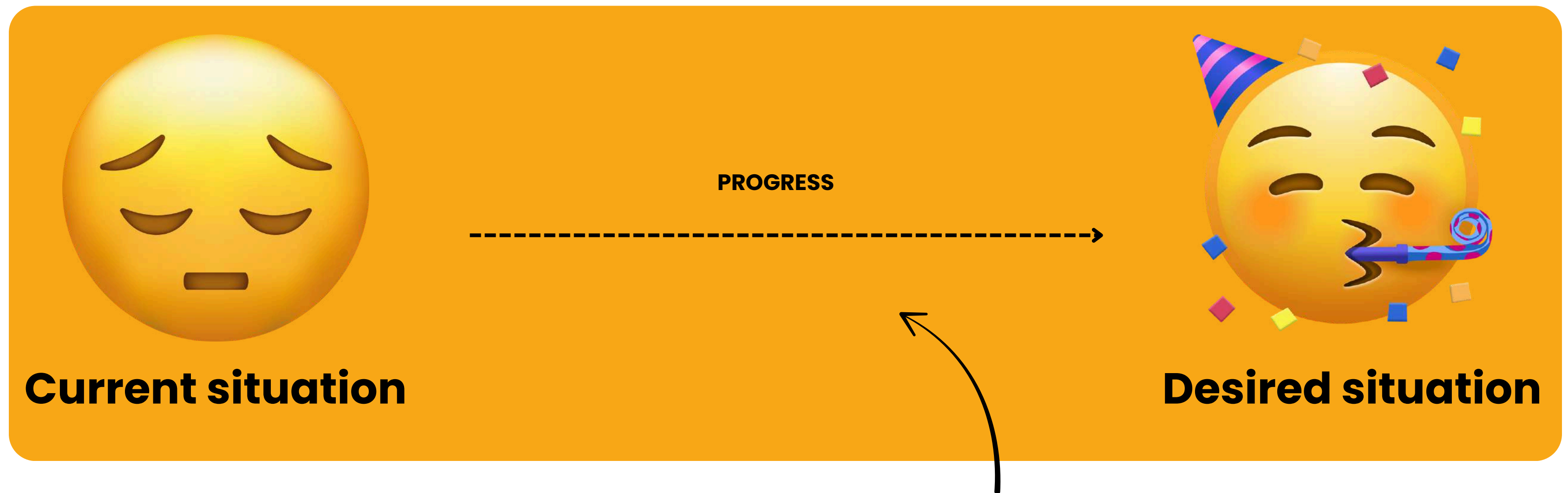
Products and services **GET HIRED** to get a job done

OR they **GET FIRED** if they fail

HIRED!

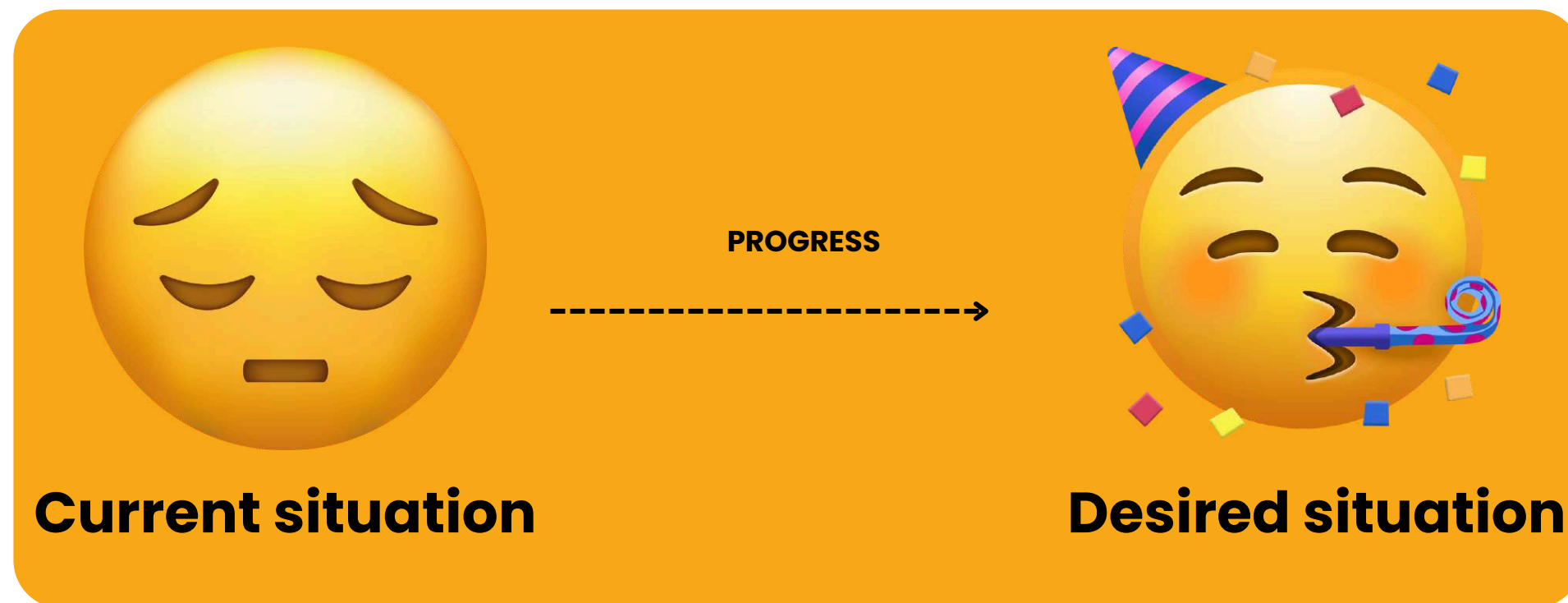


People Don't Buy Products — They Buy Progress



Customers hire your product to make this progress

Jobs have 3 dimensions



- **What I want to do? (functional)**
- **How I want to feel? (emotional)**
- **How I want to be seen by others? (Social)**

Case in Point: Heylama



Current situation

I feel awkward and avoid speaking German



Desired situation

I can confidently have small talk with my neighbors.

Dimension	Job to Be Done
Functional	Practice German speaking regularly whenever I want without scheduling expensive live tutors
Emotional	Feel confident and less anxious when talking to strangers
Social	Appear like a competent, integrated expat in Germany

***A job is not a task.
It's a transformation.***

Bob Moesta



Do B2B customers have emotional jobs?



Do B2B customers have emotional jobs?

- Decision-makers are human
- Career implications
- Risk aversion
- Desire for recognition
- Trust and relationship



B2B example: data analytics

Buyer: Head of BI or Team lead

Functional Job

I need to enable my team to quickly analyze and visualize data from multiple sources to support key business decisions.

Emotional Job

I want to feel confident that my team is trusted, efficient, and not seen as a bottleneck.

- Fear of being blamed for delays or bad decisions.
- Pride in delivering polished insights.
- Anxiety around legacy systems, slow queries, or data silos.

Social Job

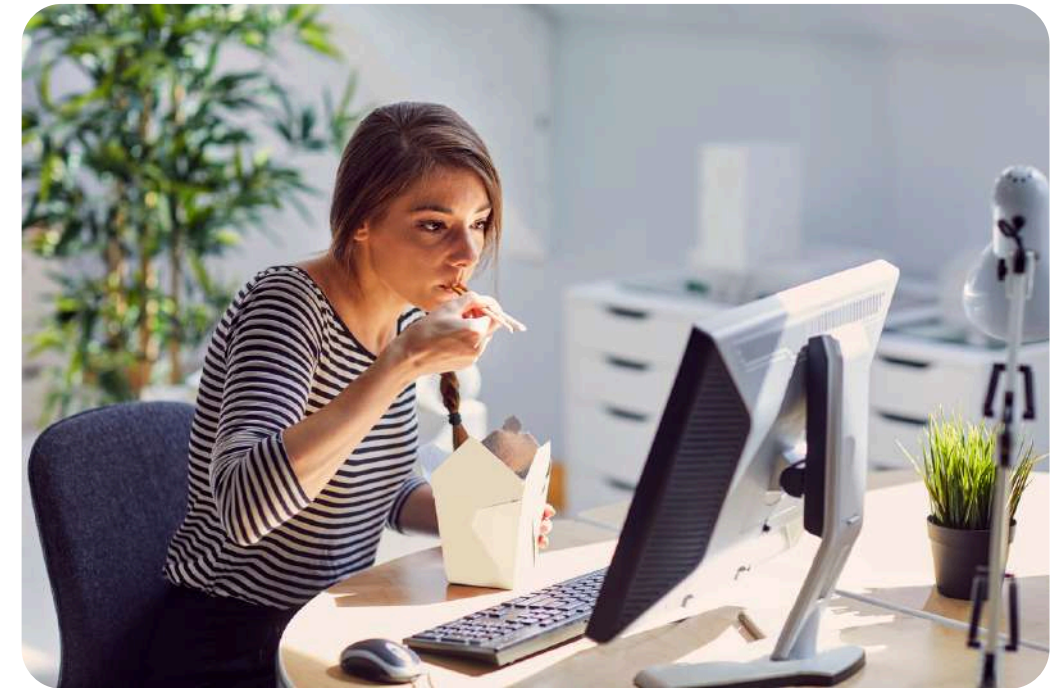
I want to be seen as a forward-thinking, competent leader who brings in modern tools and drives results.

- Impress their boss or leadership team.
- Want to be seen as progressive, not stuck with outdated tools.
- May be angling for a promotion or cross-functional recognition.



Let's look at another example

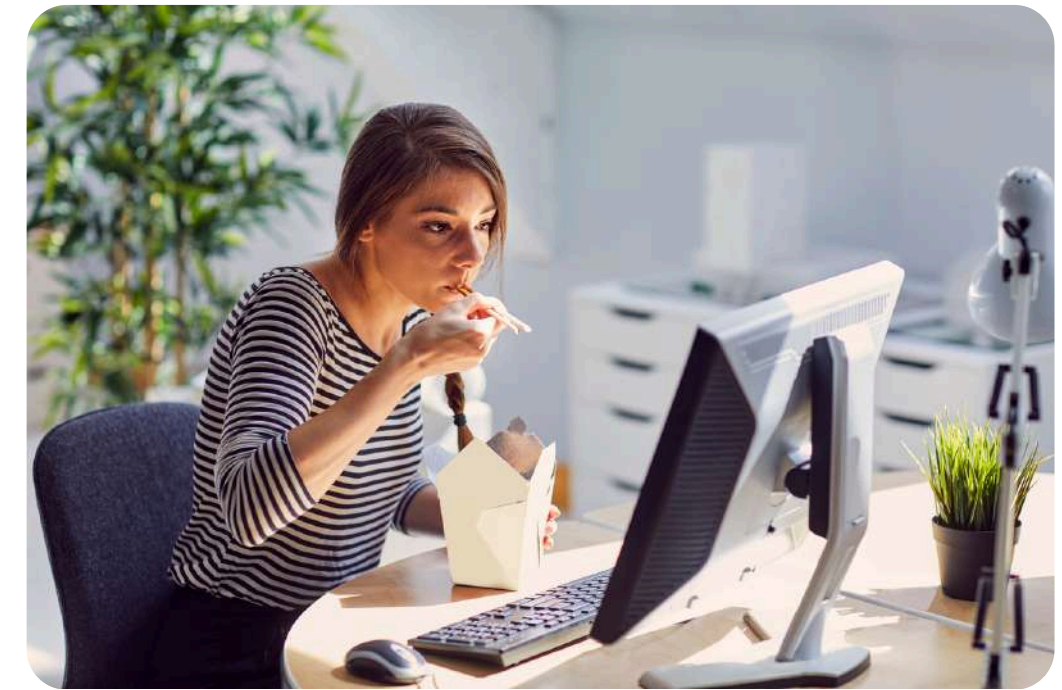
I am hungry and I want something delicious...



WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE?

Let's look at another example

I am hungry and I want something delicious...



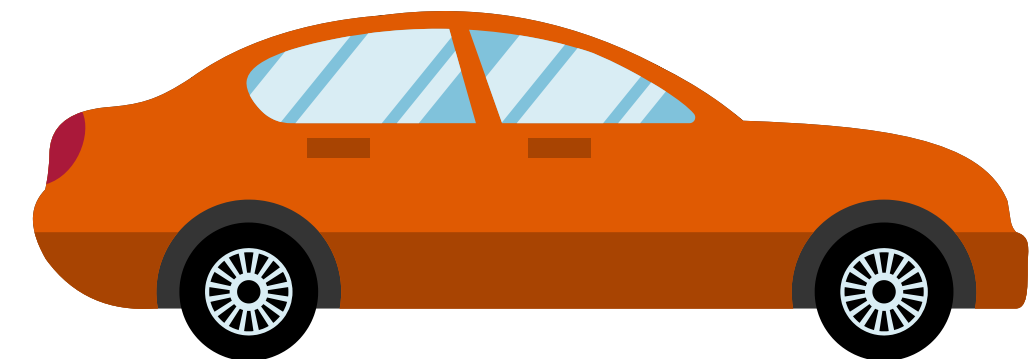
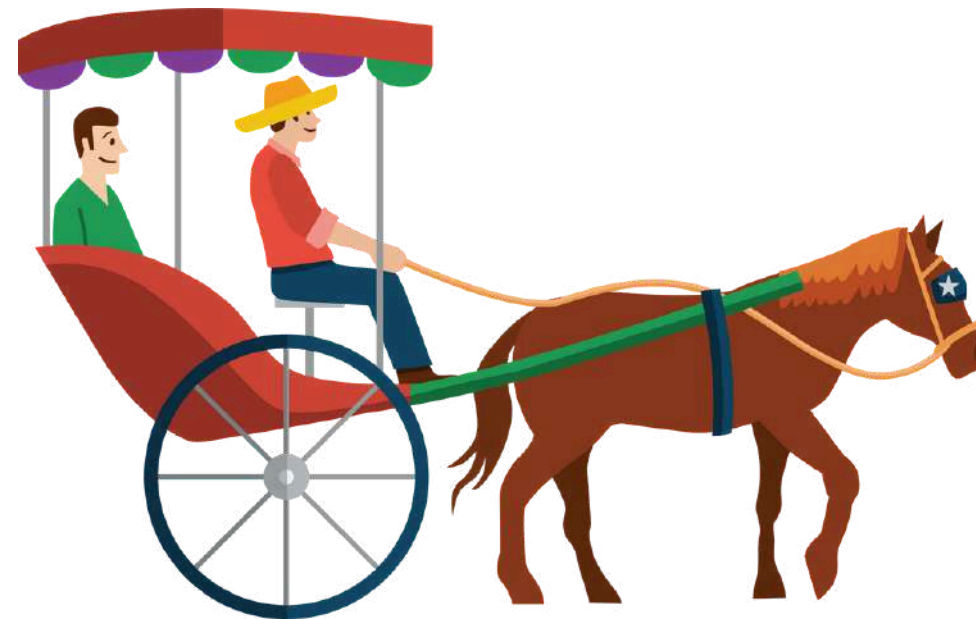
WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE?

CONTEXT

**Customer's environment and context
dictate how customers choose, what they
expect, and what they want to feel.**

Jobs are stable

- Jobs tend to remain consistent over long periods, even as technologies, products, and services change.
- The fundamental needs or desired outcomes of customers evolve much more slowly than the means to achieve them.

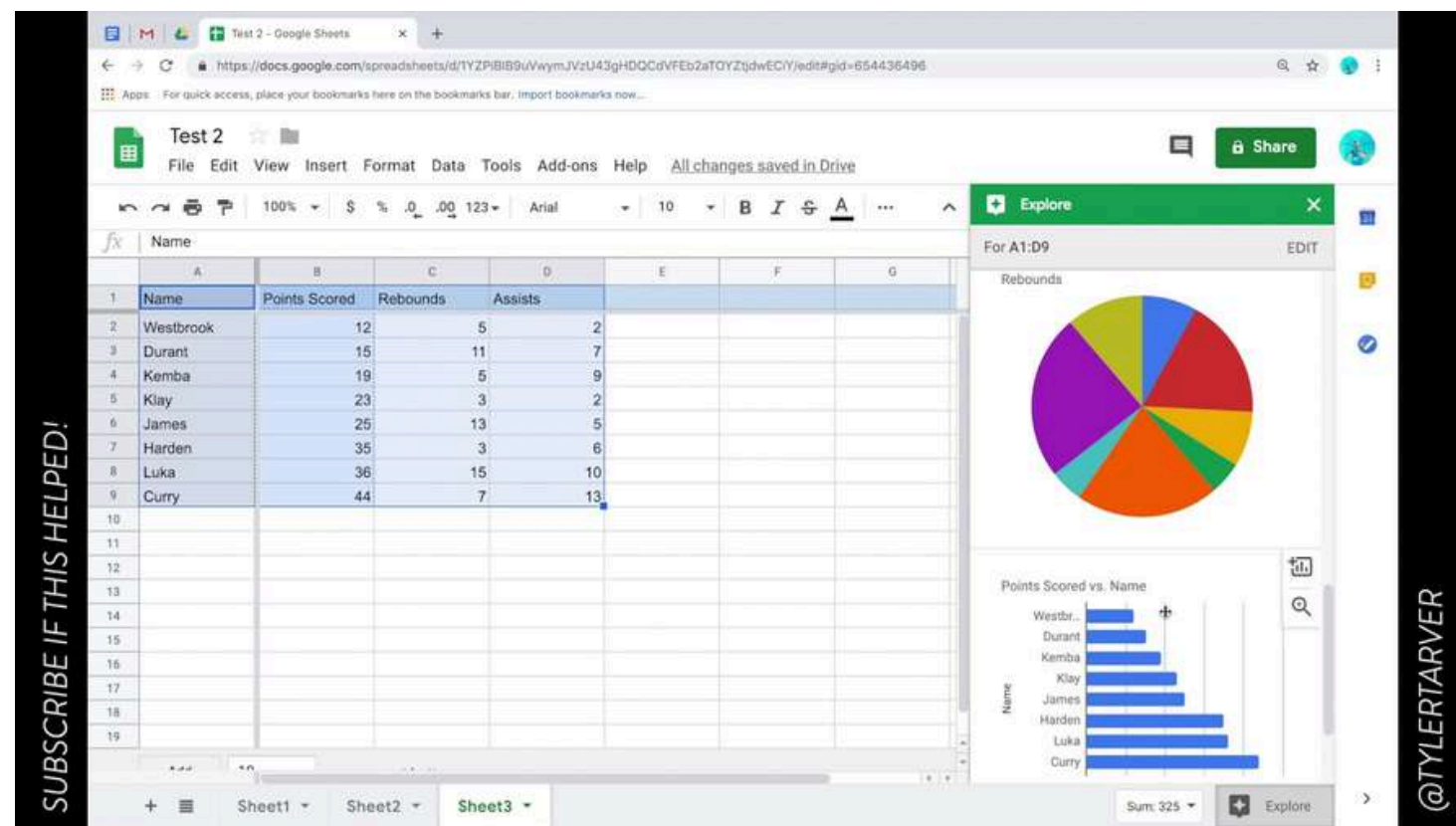


Desire to get from A to B has never changed

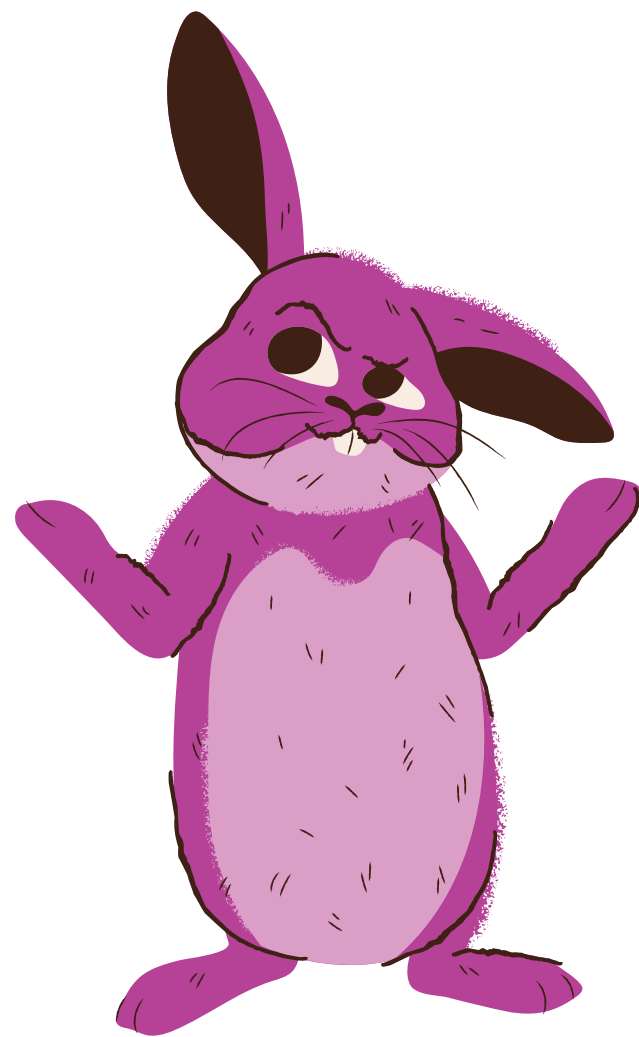
Your competition is what customers hire to do the job



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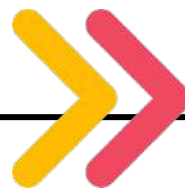


Your competition MIGHT BE A DECISION TO DO NOTHING

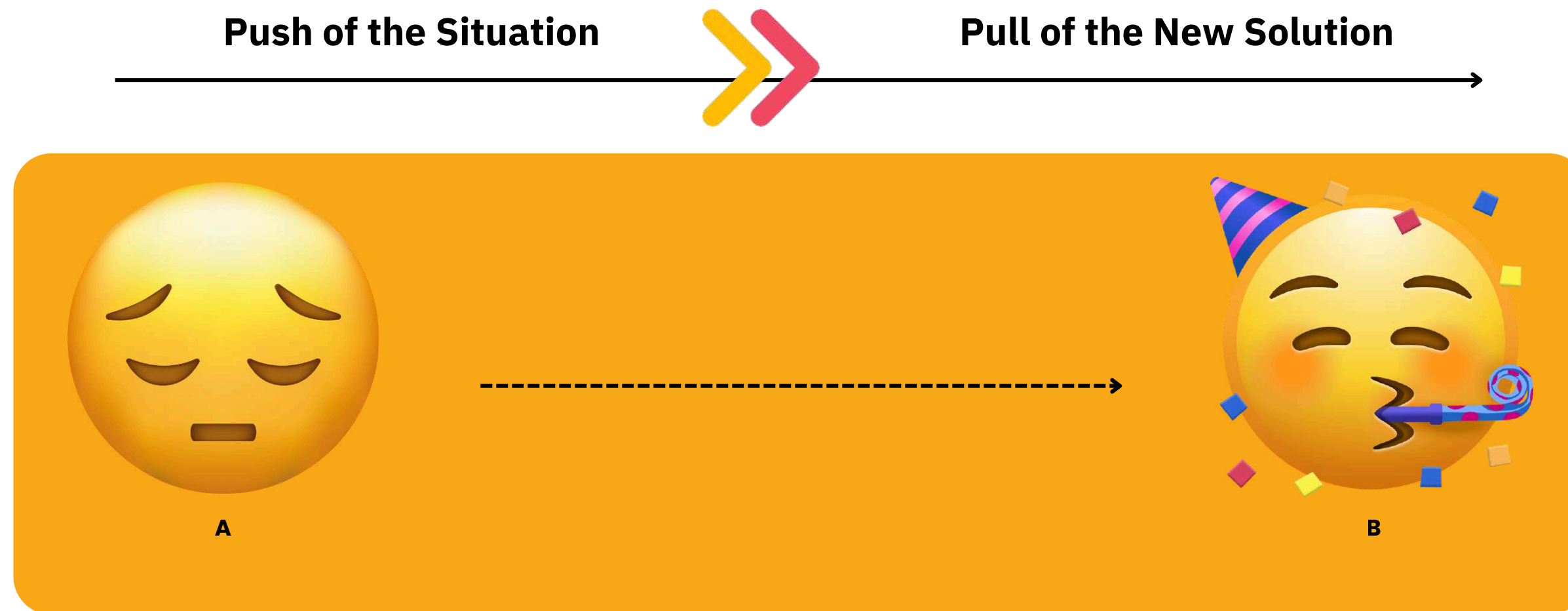


The 4 Forces of Progress

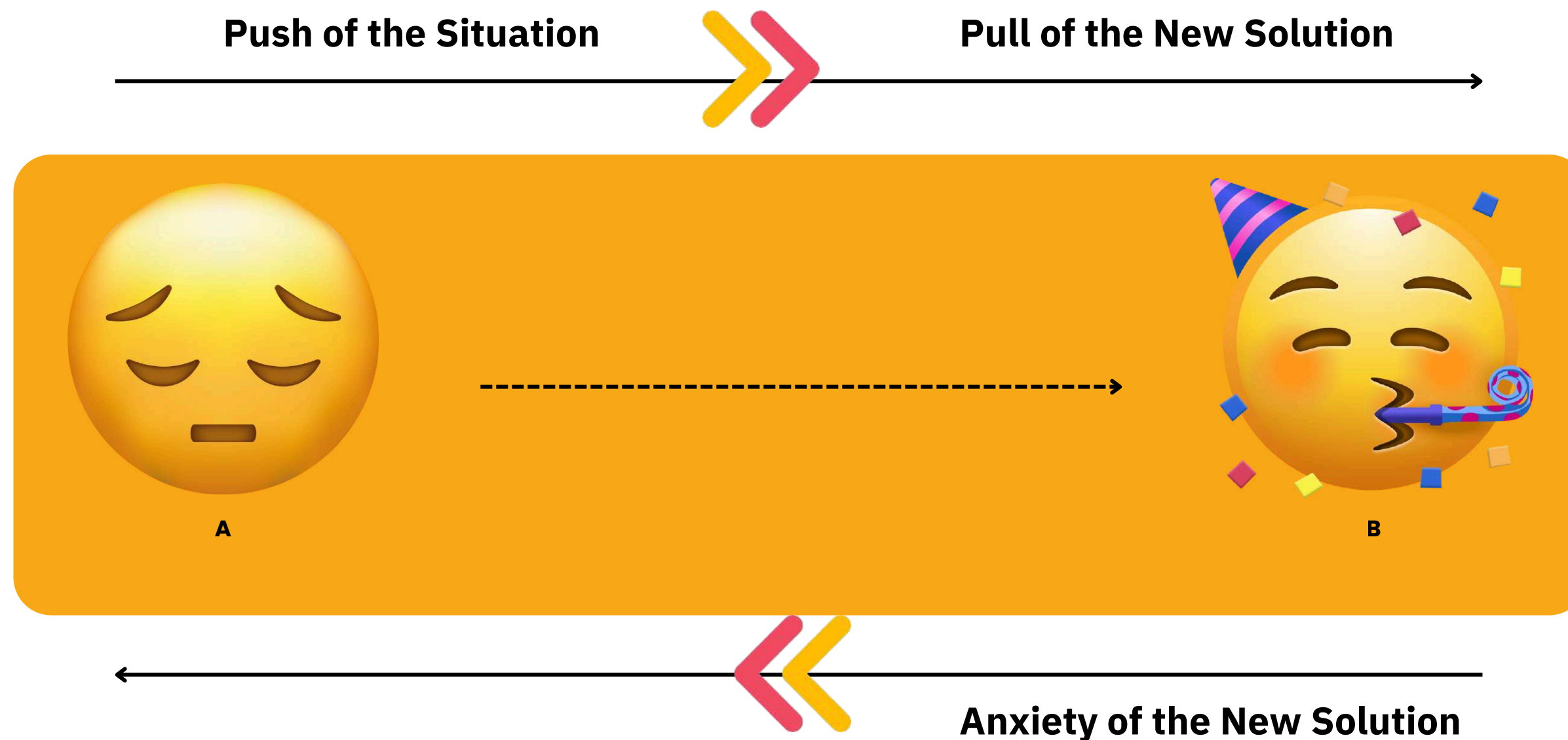
Push of the Situation



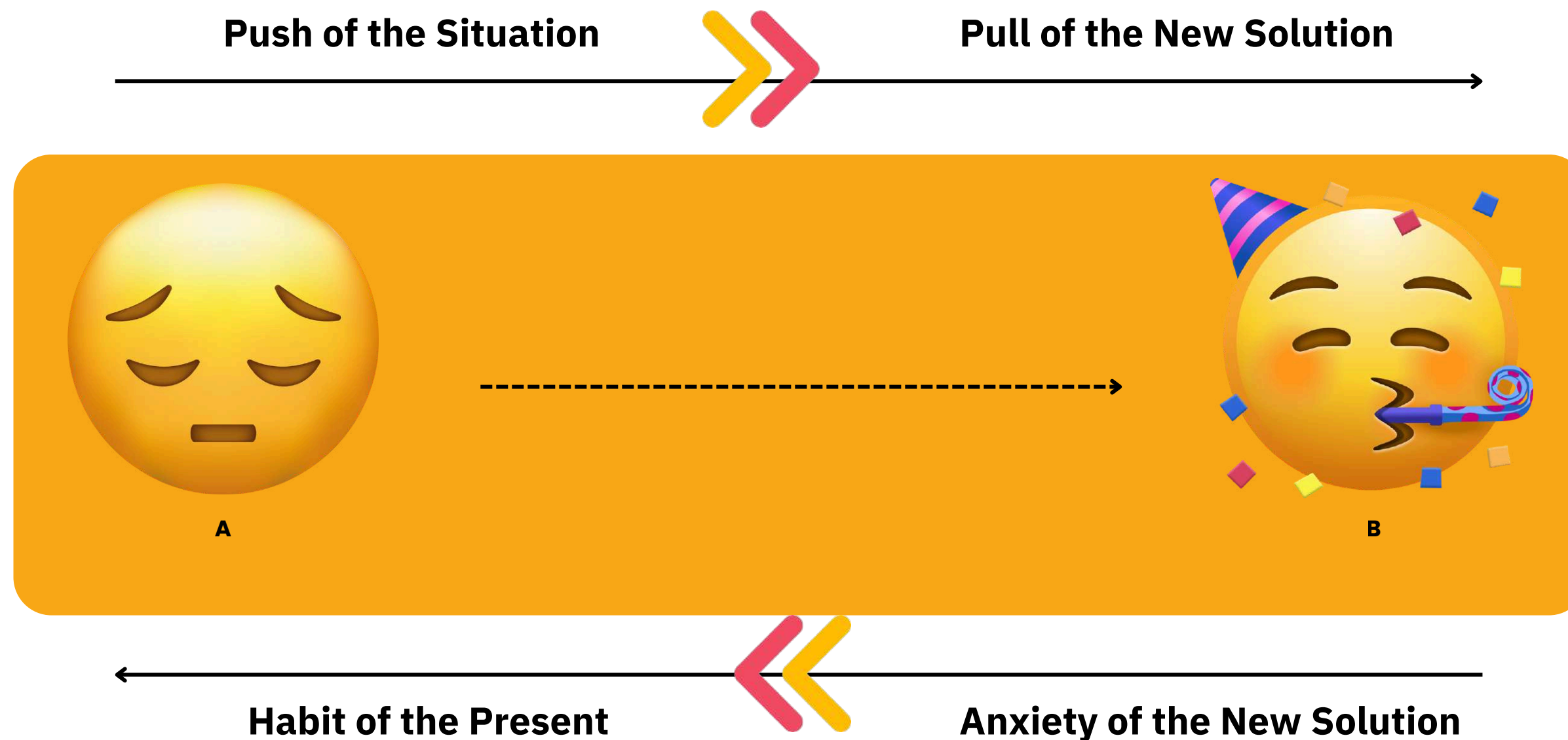
The 4 Forces of Progress



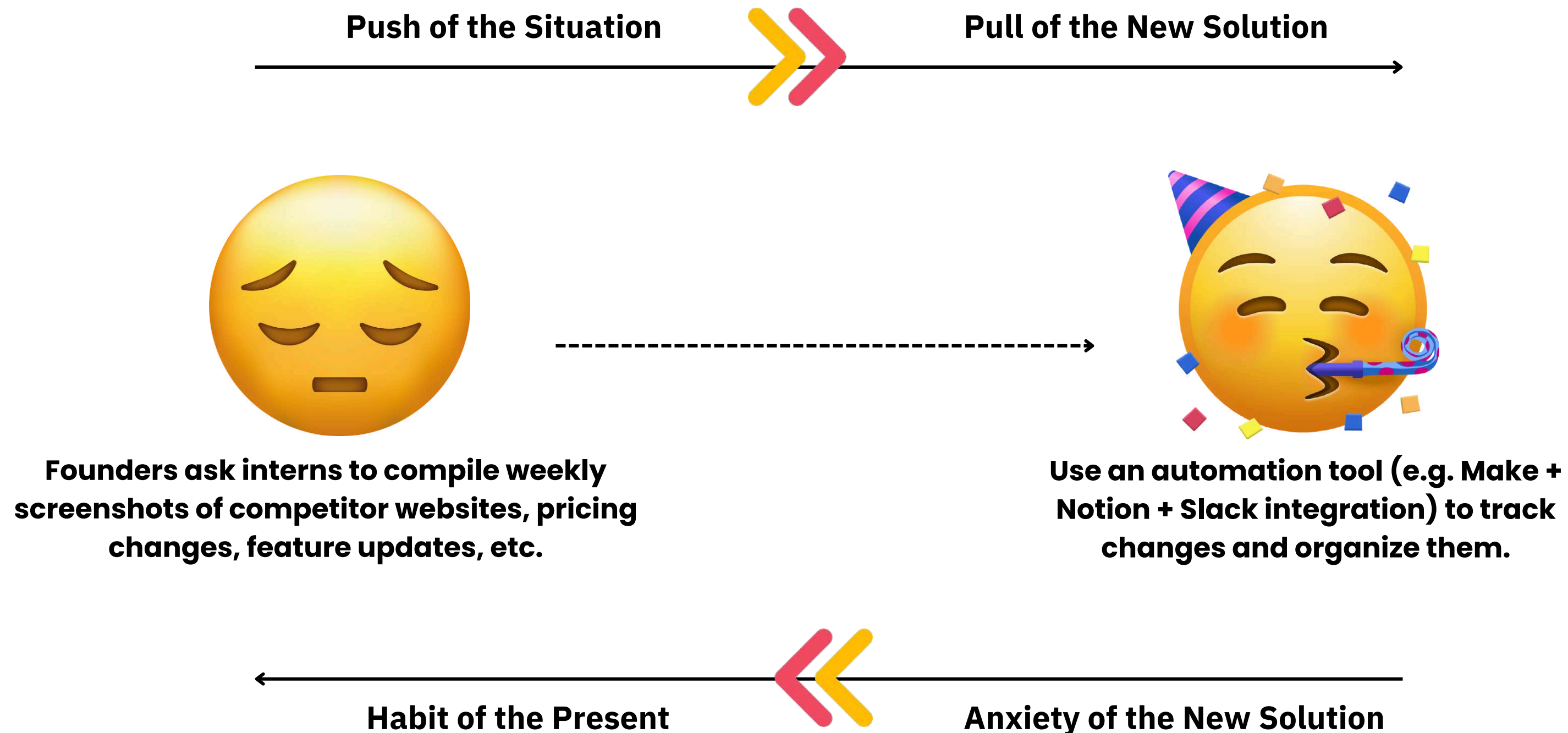
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The 4 Forces of Progress



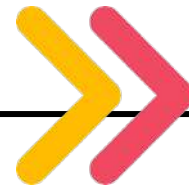
The 4 Forces of Progress

Push of the Situation

I'm tired of chasing interns for this. It's inconsistent, late, and error-prone.

Pull of the New Solution

This tool promises to do it automatically, 24/7, cover ANY number of competitors



Founders ask interns to compile weekly screenshots of competitor websites, pricing changes, feature updates, etc.



Use an automation tool (e.g. Make + Notion + Slack integration) to track changes and organize them.

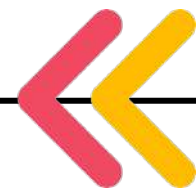


Habit of the Present

It's just easier to ask someone on the team — even if it's messy. We've always done it this way.

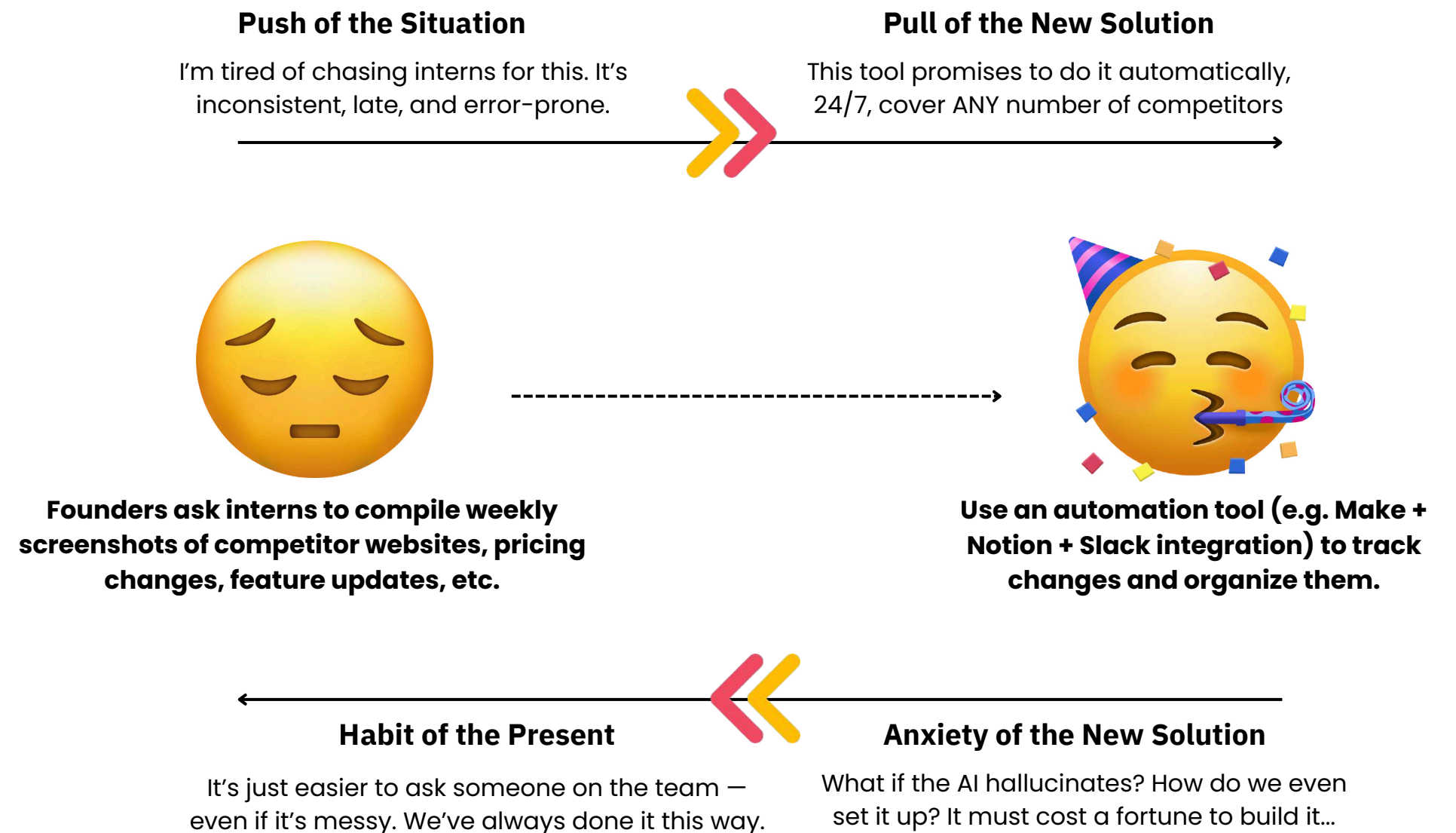
Anxiety of the New Solution

What if the AI hallucinates? How do we even set it up? It must cost a fortune to build it...



The 4 Forces of Progress

If you want buyers/users to switch, don't just show how good your product is — reduce anxiety and address their habits.



Discovering JTBD - User Interviews

What You're Looking For

- The situation (context, struggle)
- The desired outcome
- The progress they tried to make
- Existing solutions they used/hacked
- What they found frustrating
- Who else is involved

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Jobs are best uncovered through stories, not hypothetical questions or feature demos

JTBD canvas

Context

Where is the customer now?

Where does the customer want to get? (desired outcome)

Functional components

Emotional components

Social components

What forces can stop the customer from switching?

How will you address it?



Vision Far in the future

Meta-job

Break it into 1-2 year milestones

Sub-job

Sub-job